

Utilitarianism is a very clear and plausible-sounding view about ethics. This is the view which is often summed up with the slogan that one ought always to act to cause the greatest happiness for the greatest number. It is a paradigmatically unselfish theory: no one's pleasures and pains are more important than anyone else's.

Utilitarianism

An action is the right thing to do in certain circumstances if, of all the actions available in those circumstances, it would produce the highest net pleasure.

However, the view faces an important challenge which we already discussed in the context of our discussion of freedom of the will: the example of Nozick's experience machine.

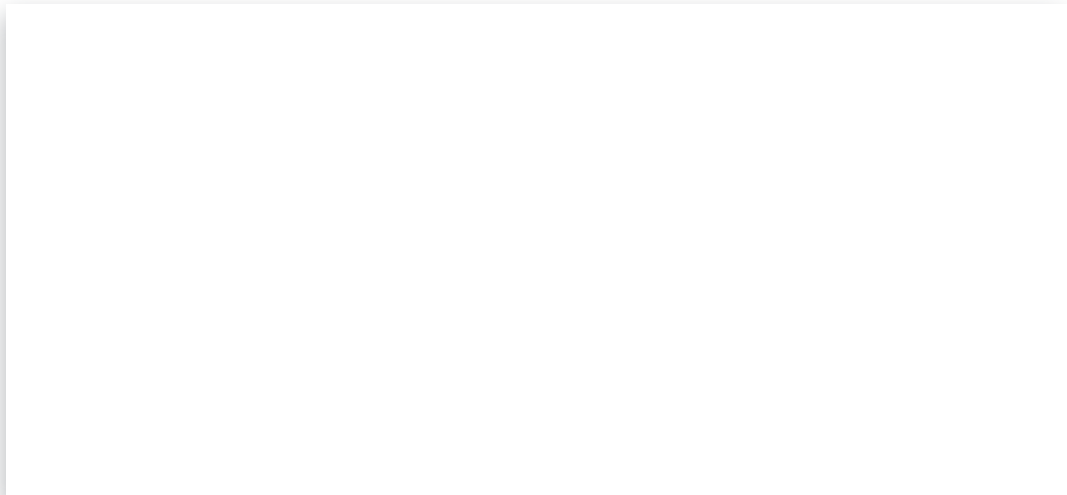
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